

as a Web site. Your first option—and this works with both FrontPage 2000 and FrontPage 98—is to buy a theme from a third-party company.

If you don't want to buy one, you can always design your own theme. FrontPage 98 came with a theme designer program on the CD. But one of the more exciting options available in FrontPage 2000 is the ability to edit an existing theme or create a new one from directly within FrontPage.

You will notice there is a 'Modify' button at the bottom of the 'Themes' dialog box. Clicking it will open up three options for editing: the Colours, the Graphics, and the Text. Modifying the colours lets you either pick a scheme for your theme, or lets you pick colours for the colour elements modified by a theme.

The colour options are all on an Internet-safe palette. Modifying the graphics gives you a chance to replace or modify any graphic element on the theme. You can create your own elements in whatever graphics program you choose. The final option, Text, lets you modify or create the text elements of your theme.

Once you are done modifying your theme or creating a new one, you simply click the 'Save As' button in the bottom of the 'Theme' dialog box, and give it a name.

Note that with Office 2000, themes are now used across the tools—Word, PowerPoint, Excel, and others. Consider making use of your new theme in everything you do.

Use Folders Effectively

 Folders make your life easier, and have the added bonus of making navigation easier for your audience. It is easy to put everything into the root directory—and that is the program default—but in fact, you don't have to, and there will come a point where you wish you didn't.

Web sites have a tendency to get large rather

quickly, and a little advance preparation is always worth the effort.

Create a folder for every group of documents you'll have on your site. Put your images in one folder, your 'about' information in another, and your documents in another.

Label the folders and directories in a way that makes sense. There is simply no need to ever have to say, "Where did I put that file?"

Use sub-folders as deep as you want if it makes sense. Remember, FrontPage keeps track of where every file is, so if you move a file from one folder to another, it will make sure the paths are correct. This is useful if you are contemplating if it would be worth it to organise that out-of-control Web site.

Not only is this technique good for you, it's also easier for the viewer. If your site starts to make sense through the URL structure, they will have another navigation tool for your site—always a good idea.

Quickly Find Clip Art

 When you open the 'Clip Art' dialog box in either FrontPage 98 or 2000, there is an under-documented button that can make your life easier. Select the 'Clips Online' button—which, in FrontPage 98, resembles the Internet Explorer shortcut symbol in the lower right hand corner—to open up the Clips Online Web Site.

The Web site will first ask you to agree to the EULA. You'll then be taken to a Web site that is updated on a regular basis, which is a searchable database of clipart, photos and sounds that are all usable as part of your FrontPage license.

You can view clips by a number of categories or types, but the real value lies in the 'search by' option where, you can enter a term on which you'd like to see some clip art. Considering the size of this database, you will surely find something. Once you do, you can either download it by selecting the piece, or

checking each piece and downloading a collection in a shopping cart-type of format when you finish looking.

If you select the piece directly, you will see the categories under which this piece was listed. You can select any of these categories to find other similar items. Use this feature if you are looking for a collection of similar pieces.

FrontPage does all the work needed to transfer the file type to something readable on the Web, and Microsoft updates this site on a regular basis.

Make Sure Your Site Works On All Browser Versions

 New to FrontPage 2000, and not well-documented, is the ability to choose the browser type and version as well as the server type that you wish to design your site for. To use this tool, open the 'Compatibility' Tab in the 'Page Options' dialog box. The browser's drop-down menu lets you choose between Netscape, IE, and WebTV, and combinations of the three.

The 'Browser Version' drop down menu lets you pick the browser version type. The Server drop-down menu lets you pick the type of server you are designing the site for. Below this are a number of technologies that are either going to be supported or not depending on if the box is checked.

You can check or uncheck any of these items. In case an item is not selected, you will not be able to create anything that uses that functionality. Not all browser types use the technologies on this dialog box. If you want to make sure that your site is as viewable on as my types of browsers as possible, deselect all the fancy options.

It is important to note that this feature won't prevent you from entering anything that uses these types of functions directly into the HTML.

HTML Formatting And Optional Reformatting

 You can tell FrontPage 2002 how your HTML

Bet You Didn't Know

Make Sure Your Colours Can Be Seen

There are dozens of different browsers out there. Not all of them use colour, but for those who do, you need what is known as a 'Web Safe Palette'.

When you select the colour options anywhere from within FrontPage, the dialog box mentions 'More Colors'. Clicking that button shows you several more colours available—it opens up the 'More Colors' dialog box. Everything in that box is a Web Safe colour. Any of those will work on any browser that displays colour.

page should be formatted, from how many indents should come before each tag, or whether or not to use optional tags.

By default, FrontPage preserves the formatting of existing HTML, but applies new HTML formatting to content you add to the existing page. HTML formatting is viewed in the HTML pane.

The formatting options you choose will apply to all pages you create in FrontPage. New in FrontPage 2002 is the ability to take a page that has been imported into your Web site and reformat it according to your preferences.

In order to apply your HTML formatting preferences to a Web page, open it in FrontPage 2002 and perform the following: go to **Tools > Page Options**, and then click the HTML Source tab. Click 'Reformat using the rules below'. Then under 'Formatting', select the options you want.

For instance, if you would like all tags to appear as lowercase instead of uppercase, select 'Tag names are lowercase'.

Under Tags, select the tag and attributes you want. For example, select 'Body', and then change indent to 12 spaces. FrontPage will change the HTML pages you create in FrontPage to use these formatting rules. 